Assignment Brief
Management of People and Finance
Academic Year

Unit Information:	
Qualification:	**Foundation Diploma in Business / CS & IT (SCQF Level 6 – Equivalent to A Level)**
Unit Code & Title:	_____
Assignment Title:	**Assignment 1** LO1 – Task A: Report (Individual) LO2 - Task B: Report (Individual) Total Marks: 100
Results Reporting:	Assignment 1: Task 1: Task 2: Task 3:

Date of Issue:	**Due Date:**

<u>To be Filled by the Student</u>

Student USN:

College Name & Site:

Tutor:

Date Due:

Date of Submission:

*All work must be submitted on or before the due date. If an extension of time to submit work is required, a Mitigating Circumstance Form must be submitted.

Has an extension been approved? ☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please provide the new submission date ……./….. /……., and affix appropriate evidence.

First Marker:	**Second Marker:**
Agreed Mark:	**Refer: Yes / No**

General Guidelines for Assessment

1. Attach a title page to your assignment. Use the previous page as your cover sheet and ensure that you fill in the details correctly.
2. All assignment work should be prepared using word processing software and should be organized and clearly structured

Word Processing Guidance

1. Use a font type that makes it easy for your examiner to read, for example, Arial or Times New Roman.
2. Use 1.5-line line spacing. Left-justify all paragraphs.
3. Ensure that all headings are consistent in terms of size and font style.
4. **Use the footer function to insert your Student USN, Name, Unit Title, Unit Code, and Page Number on each page**.
5. Use the spell check and grammar check functions to check your assignment.

Assignment Submission

1. Ensure that you give yourself enough time to complete the assignment by the due date. You must take responsibility for managing your own time effectively.
2. Submit an electronic version uploaded to the student learning management system on or before the stated deadline.
3. Submissions received up to 72 hours after the deadline will be penalized in line with JAIN College's Late Submission Policy. Thereafter, submissions will not be accepted.
4. If you are unable to hand in your assignment on time and have valid reasons, such as illness, you may apply (in writing) for an extension under the terms of the JAIN COLLEGE Mitigating Circumstances Policy.
5. Non-submission of work without a valid reason will lead to an automatic REFERRAL. You will then be asked to complete an alternative assignment. Your work will be capped at a PASS.

Declaration of Authenticity

6. Exercise meticulous care when incorporating the work or ideas of others into your assignment. Ensure that all sources are accurately acknowledged using the Harvard referencing system, both within the text and in the bibliography. Failure to provide proper attribution may result in an investigation and potential penalties for plagiarism, in accordance with the JAIN College Malpractice Policy

Statement of Originality and Student Declaration

I hereby declare that I fully understand the concept of plagiarism, which includes the use of another individual's work and its presentation as my own without proper and accurate attribution of sources. I further acknowledge my awareness of what constitutes copying or the use of another's work without appropriate academic acknowledgement.

1. I know that plagiarism is a punishable offence because it constitutes theft, and the consequences of plagiarism as outlined in the Malpractice Policy.
2. I understand JAIN College's plagiarism, ghost writing and copying policy.
3. I declare that all work presented by me for every aspect of this assignment is my own, and where I have made use of another's work, I have rightly attributed the source.
4. I acknowledge that the attachment of this document, signed or not, constitutes my agreement to the above.
5. I understand that my assignment will not be considered as submitted if this declaration is not included.

Student's Signature: …… Date: ……

Assignment:
Task 1: Article

Having gained valuable knowledge on effective study methods, you're now equipped to share these insights with future students at your school or college.

Write an essay titled "Effective Study Strategies for Business Studies: Insights for Future Students" to be published on your school's website. This article should provide practical advice and tips for students who are preparing to study business. It should focus on the following key points:

- Effective Study Techniques: Discuss strategies that have proven effective for studying business subjects.
- Personal Insights: Offer personal tips and methods that have worked well for you.
- Examples and Illustrations: Include real-life examples and illustrations to make your advice more relatable and practical.

Your goal is to make the article both engaging and informative, helping prospective business students prepare for their studies with confidence. While writing the essay ensure to keep the following into consideration and discuss:

- Effective strategies for developing high-quality academic work.
- Compare different note-taking methods and advise their effectiveness in different learning scenarios.
- Describe i methods for improving reading comprehension and retention of study material.
- Explain the methods, sources of research, research process and role of ethics in research
- Explain the best practices to avoid plagiarism and prevent other forms of academic misconduct.
- Identify key factors that contribute to poor academic performance
- Describe various time management methods and their impact on academic performance.
- Describe Gardner's theory of multiple intelligences and its application to learning.
- Examine various learning styles and recommend strategies to enhance learning efficiency.

This task assesses performance criteria 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4, 2.1, 2.2, 2.3 3.1, 3.2, 4.1, 4.2

Instructions:
Your article should not exceed **1000** word

Effective Study Strategies for Business Studies: Insights for Future Students

Studying Business Studies is an exciting journey that combines analytical thinking, strategic planning, and real-world application. However, success in this subject requires more than just attending lectures and reading textbooks.

As someone who has recently completed key phases of business education, I've gained practical knowledge of study techniques that can make a real difference. In this article, I'll share effective study strategies, personal tips, and proven methods to help you thrive in Business Studies.

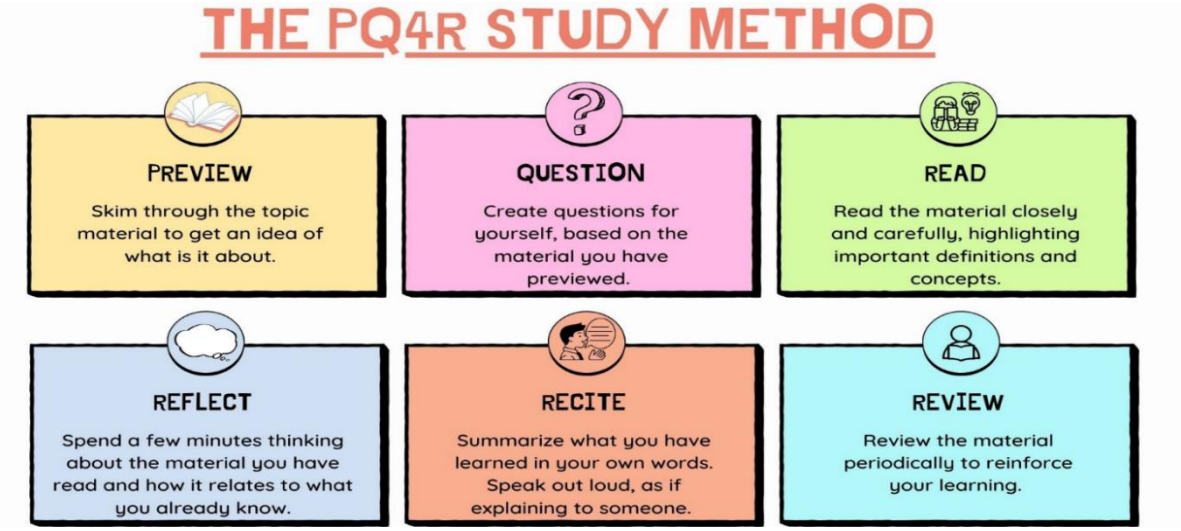
Effective Study Techniques

Mastering business studies involves more than just reading textbooks, it requires active engagement with the material. To master these topics, use a combination of active recall, spaced repetition, and interleaved learning.

- **Active Learning Methods**: Techniques like the Feynman Technique, where you explain concepts in your own words, can deepen understanding. Similarly, the PQ4R method (Preview, Question, Read, Reflect, Recite, Review) encourages active reading and comprehension.

- **Spaced Repetition**: Instead of cramming, spreading out study sessions over time helps in better retention of information.

- **Case Study Analysis**: Practicing with real-world case studies sharpens critical thinking and application of theoretical concepts. (Holt, 2023)



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Time Management Tips

Managing your time helps reduce stress and gets better results. Try these:

- **Pomodoro**: Study for 25 minutes, then take a 5-minute break.
- **Time Blocking**: Plan your day and give each task its own time slot.
- Use apps like Google Calendar to remind you of deadlines.

Planning ahead helps you avoid last-minute stress.

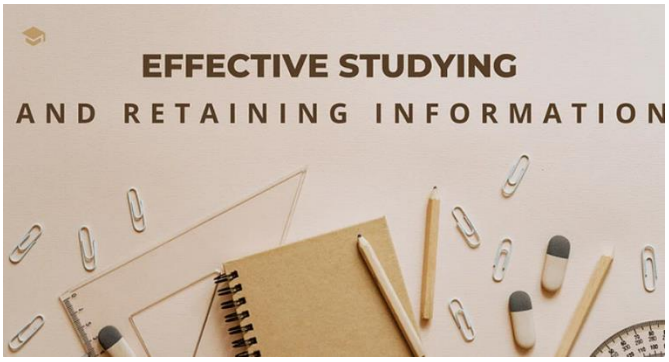
Personal Insights and Tips

What worked well for me was a mix of structured study schedule, active class participation, and practical application. Creating a weekly planner and setting SMART goals (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) kept me focused.

Moreover, these blending multiple methods gave the best results. Here are a few personal strategies:

- **Study Groups**: Explaining concepts to peers helped reinforce my own understanding. Choose your group wisely - committed and focused peers can elevate your learning experience.

- **Teach-Back Method**: After studying a topic, try teaching it to someone else. This method helped me identify gaps in my understanding.



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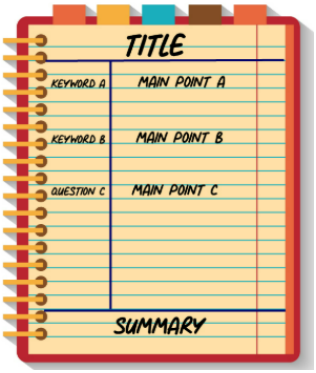
Note-Taking Methods: Comparison and Recommendations

There's no one-size-fits-all approach to note-taking. Here's a comparison of some popular methods:

- **Cornell Method**: Best for summarizing and reviewing. Divide your page into notes, cues, and summary sections.
- **Outlining Method**: Effective for logically structured content, such as business laws or financial regulations.
- **Mind Mapping**: Creating visual representations of concepts can aid in understanding and recalling complex information.
- **Charting Method**: Useful for comparing features - for example, comparing leadership styles or investment options. (Goodnotes, 2024)

Choose the method that suits your learning style. I found that using mind maps and charting method before exams helped consolidate large amounts of information quickly.

Improving Reading Comprehension and Retention



Business textbooks can be dense and filled with jargon. To improve comprehension:

- Preview the text by reading headings, subheadings, and summaries.
- Use the SQ3R method: Survey, Question, Read, Recite, Review.
- Take notes while reading and use highlighters for key points.
- Summarize each chapter in your own words. (AdLit, 2020)

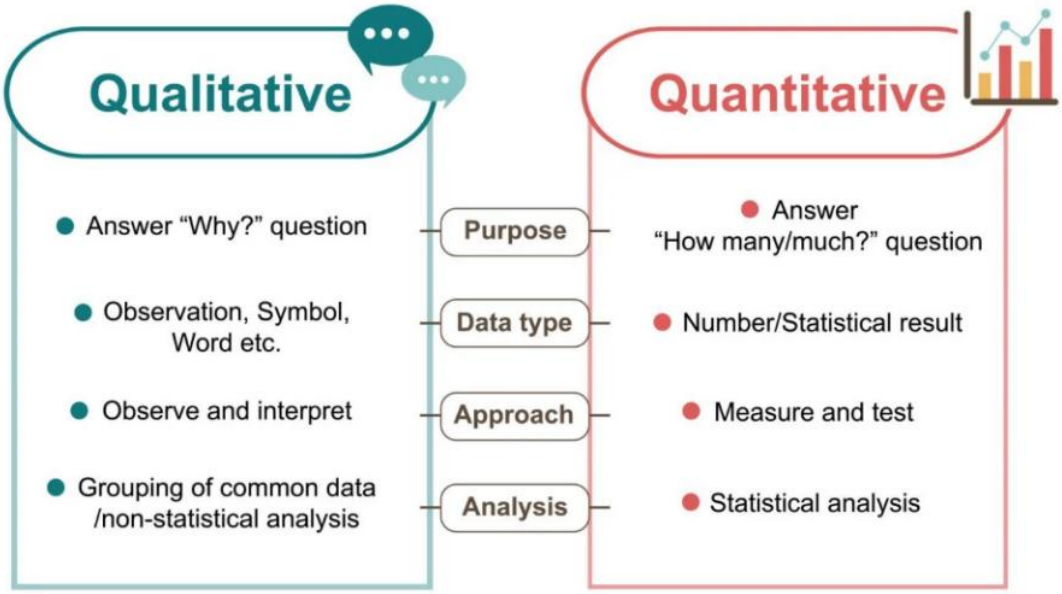
Research Methods and Ethics

Conducting high-quality academic work involves:

- **Understanding Research Methods**: Familiarize yourself with both qualitative and quantitative research techniques. (McLeod, n.d.)

- **Ethical Considerations**: Ensure honesty in data collection and reporting. Avoid fabrication or falsification of data.

- **Proper Citation**: Always credit original sources to maintain academic integrity.



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Avoiding Plagiarism and Academic Misconduct

Maintaining academic integrity is paramount:

- **Paraphrase Effectively**: When rephrasing, ensure the original meaning is preserved and cite the source.

Avoid misconduct by:

- Not sharing or copying assignments.
- Using only approved resources.
- Acknowledging collaborative work where required.

Key Factors Behind Poor Academic Performance

Poor time management, lack of motivation, unclear goals, and ineffective study habits (trying to memorize without understanding, or not reviewing notes) are major causes of underperformance. Additionally, ignoring feedback, missing classes, or passive learning can hinder progress.

Recognize early signs of struggle - such as low grades or falling behind and seek support from tutors, mentors, or peers.

To do better, stay organized, ask questions, and review your work often. (VICTORIA UNIVERSITY, n.d.)

Gardner's Theory of Multiple Intelligences

Howard Gardner proposed that people have different kinds of intelligences - linguistic, logical-mathematical, interpersonal, intrapersonal, spatial, musical, bodily-kinesthetic, and naturalistic. Business students often benefit from:

- **Interpersonal intelligence** for teamwork and communication.
- **Logical-mathematical intelligence** for problem-solving and data analysis.
- **Intrapersonal intelligence** for self-awareness and reflection.

Understanding your dominant intelligences allows you to tailor your learning strategies—for example, role-playing scenarios for interpersonal learners or using charts and graphs for visual-spatial learners. (Marenus, 2025)

What Worked for Me

I made a study plan each week and set small goals, like finishing one topic a day. I also joined a study group, which helped me learn faster. One trick I really liked: **teaching others**. When I explained a topic to a friend, it helped me understand it better too.

Conclusion

Success in Business Studies depends not just on what you study, but how you study. By using a variety of study techniques, managing your time effectively, understanding your learning style, and conducting ethical research, you'll be well-prepared to meet academic challenges. Remember, it's not about working harder - it's about working smarter. Start building these habits now, and you'll lay a solid foundation for both academic success and future professional excellence.

References

Anon., 2020. *AdLit.* [Online]
Available at: https://www.adlit.org/in-the-classroom/strategies/sq3r-survey-question-read-recite-review

Anon., 2024. *Goodnotes.* [Online]
Available at: https://www.goodnotes.com/blog/note-taking-methods

Anon., n.d. *VICTORIA UNIVERSITY.* [Online]
Available at: https://www.vu.edu.au/about-vu/news-events/study-space/10-tips-on-how-to-study-effectively

Holt, P., 2023. *AdLit.* [Online]
Available at: https://e-student.org/pq4r-study-method/

Marenus, M., 2025. *Simply Psychology.* [Online]
Available at: https://www.simplypsychology.org/multiple-intelligences.html/

McLeod, S., n.d. *Simply Psychology.* [Online]
Available at: https://www.simplypsychology.org/qualitative-quantitative.html
[Accessed 16 May 2025].

Task 2 - Preliminary Study

You must select a topic from any of the field that interests you. Produce a brief of not more than **600 words.**

Following information must be included in the study:

- a record of information and how you have collated this
- a table of the techniques applied to gather the information.
- adherence to correct citation of appropriate sources
- a reference list
- a list of relevant sources

This task assesses performance criteria 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3

Social Media and Youth

Abstract

Social media has emerged as a powerful force shaping the behavior, communication, and mental health of today's youth. This article explores the dual impact of social platforms on young people's lives, both the opportunities and the risks. The analysis is supported by secondary research from academic journals, health organizations, and digital behavior studies.

Introduction

Social media has become an integral part of everyday life, especially for youth. With over 90% of youth globally active platforms such as Instagram, Snapchat, TikTok, and Facebook is a central part of modern youth culture. They provide young people with opportunities to communicate, learn, entertain themselves, and express their identities. While social media offers many benefits, it also raises concerns, including mental health risks, cyberbullying, and reduced face-to-face interactions. This article explores how social media influences youth today, based on data gathered from reliable academic and professional sources.

Positive Effects:

- **Connectivity & Expression**: Social-media allows youth to stay connected, express ideas, and build networks globally.

- **Educational Access**: Platforms like YouTube, Reddit, and online forums offer tutorials, study groups, and peer advice, making it easier for students to learn outside the classroom.

- **Social Awareness**: Many youths are now more informed about global issues like climate change, gender equality, and mental health due to campaigns and discussions on social media.

Negative Effects:

- **Mental Health Issues**: Studies link excessive use of social media with anxiety, depression, and low self-esteem
- **Cyberbullying**: Young users often face online harassment, which affects psychological well-being.
- **Addiction & Distraction**: Prolonged screen time can interfere with academics and personal development.
- **Reduce face-to-face interactions**: Youth becoming more comfortable behind screens than in real-life interactions.

Conclusion

Social media is a powerful force in shaping the thoughts, behavior, and well-being of today's youth. While it brings significant benefits in terms of education, connection, and awareness, it also poses serious challenges, particularly to mental health and interpersonal development. It is vital for parents, educators, and policymakers to guide youth in using social media responsibly and to create safer online environments that promote healthy growth.

Research Question

- What are the major effects of social media on young people?
- Are these effects more positive or negative?
- Which areas of their life are most impacted - mental health, academics, relationships, behavior?

Research Objectives

1. To examine both positive and negative psychological effects of social media on youth.
2. To identify patterns of social media usage among adolescents.
3. To analyze existing research on the long-term impact of digital interaction on youth development.

Identifying Gaps and Focus Areas

After exploring academic articles, news reports, and surveys, I noticed that the biggest concern among researchers and educators is the behavioral and psychological impact of social media on young people. This includes:

- Increased anxiety and depression
- Educational distraction
- Benefits like connectivity and awareness

How the Data Was Collected

1. **Identifying Key Areas of Focus**

First, I outlined the key subtopics relevant to the impact of social media on youth:

- Mental health
- Educational benefits
- Body image and self-esteem

2. **Information Record and Collation Method**

To collate relevant and up-to-date information, I used a mix of academic databases, and different sites. Searches were conducted using keywords such as "youth and social media," "mental health impact of social media".

3. **Keyword Search**

I used the following search terms on Google Search and Google Scholar:

- "Impact of social media on teenage mental health"
- "Social media addiction in youth"
- "Social media and cyberbullying statistics"
- "Positive and negative effects of social media on students"

Works Cited

Linda C. Ashar, J. (2024, February 05). *AMERICAN PUBLIC UNIVERSITY*. Retrieved from https://www.apu.apus.edu/area-of-study/business-and-management/resources/how-social-media-sites-affect-society/

NEWPORT ACADEMY. (2024, April 17). Retrieved from https://www.newportacademy.com/resources/well-being/effect-of-social-media-on-teenagers/

Raju, G. (2025, May 09). *simplilearn*. Retrieved from https://www.simplilearn.com/real-impact-social-media-article

Task 3

Introspective Reflective Analysis:

This task must be done the end of the course. You are required to complete a self-analysis in which you reflect on your strength and weaknesses in terms of study skills and your personal learning style.

You should also discuss how you intend to improve your study habits and overcome your weaknesses.

The self-reflection should not be more than **400 words.** You can use different presentation forms like tables, chart etc. to make work look more appealing.

Note – this task should be about you and NOT a general study guide.

This task assesses performance criteria 3.3, 3.4 and 4.3

Reflecting on my academic journey, I recognize areas of strength and opportunities for growth in my study habits and learning preferences. This aims to outline my personal strengths, weaknesses, and the steps I will take to grow as a learner.

Personal Learning Style

I identify most with a visual and kinesthetic learning style. I understand information better when I can see it in diagrams, mind maps, or videos. Hands-on activities, such as group tasks or practice-based assignments, help me retain information longer. However, I sometimes struggle with long reading tasks or lectures without visuals.

Strength

Area	Strengths
Note-taking	I capture key points during lectures, aiding in better understanding and revision.
Time management	I effectively plan and allocate time for tasks, ensuring deadlines are met.
Test preparations	I engage in regular self-assessments through practice exams.

Weaknesses

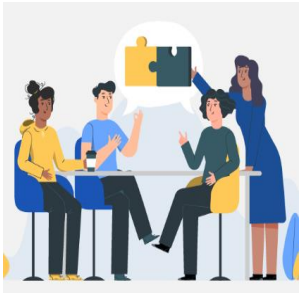
Area	Weaknesses
Procrastination	I occasionally delay starting assignments, leading to last-minute stress and reduced quality of work.
Distractions	I sometimes struggle to maintain focus during study sessions, particularly when studying in environments with potential interruptions.
Active Participation	I find it challenging to actively engage in group discussions and collaborative activities.

Strategies for Improvement

To address my weaknesses and build upon my strengths, I plan to implement the following strategies:

Overcoming Procrastination:

- Break tasks into smaller, manageable segments.
- Set specific, achievable goals with deadlines.



Increasing Active Participation:

- Actively contribute to group discussions and study sessions.
- Seek opportunities for collaborative projects to enhance learning.
- Engage in peer teaching to reinforce understanding.

Active Recall: Testing yourself on the material rather than just reviewing it.
This technique strengthens memory retention.

Breaks: Adopt this time-management method by studying in focused intervals of 1 hour followed by 15-minute breaks to enhance concentration and reduce burnout.

Time-Blocking: Allocate specific time slots for different subjects or tasks to ensure balanced study sessions.

Conclusion

By recognizing my strengths and weaknesses, I can adopt targeted strategies to improve my study habits and learning outcomes. Embracing my personal learning style and committing to continuous self-assessment will empower me to achieve academic success.

MARKING CRITERIA

Assessment Marking Criteria	Marks
Understand how to search and evaluate reading material from different sources and describe the process of producing authentic academic work	**20**
Explain different methods and sources of research and understand the importance of ethics in research	**20**
Explain the reasons for poor academic performance and understand the importance and application of personal time management in developing independent study skills	**20**
Understand different learning styles	**20**
Conduct and present findings from a mini research project	**20**
TOTAL	**100**

The pass mark for this assignment is 40%

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